

ANNEX · 26 AUGUST 2026

This annex is the companion to the 26 August 2026 edition and is built every day. The edition is capped at eight pages; material is RELOCATED here, never deleted. Section numbering tracks the edition: **A1** carries the full commentary for the three live-tape tables and the gasoline chart, plus the full strait-operational table; **A2.3** the full cross-asset and macro record; **A7** the source log; **A8** the on-demand update protocol; **A9** the methodology; **A10** the anchor and trigger levels. A figure marked NOT OBTAINED is absent from the record, not unchanged.

A1 · LIVE TAPE — FULL COMMENTARY

A1.1 · Data integrity — all three standing checks

Row-level check (\$9.8): CLEARS. The 25 August row is live — no field on it is identical to the 24 August close, and the row carries MOVE, VIX and a full curve. The 24 August row is likewise live.

Field-level identical-to-4dp check (\$9.35): TWO FIRINGS, both on the 24 August row. SOFR printed 3.65, identical to four decimal places to the 21 August close, and AUTMUSAG printed \$4.82, identical to the 21 August value. Both are reported UNRESOLVED and no day-on-day change is asserted for either. AUTMUSAG has now shown \$4.82 on four consecutive dates (19, 20, 21 and 24 August), which cannot be distinguished on the terminal alone from a frozen field. The 26 August intraday row carries no identical-to-4dp field; AsiaLNG, MOVE, VIX, SOFR, GasAAA and GasDOE simply have no 26 August print and are reported blank rather than carried (\$9.9).

\$9.35 IS VINDICATED FOR A THIRD TIME, and it is worth stating plainly because it is this monitor's own rule being tested against its own data. The 21 August edition reported the 30-year as UNRESOLVED because it printed 5.2476%, identical to four decimals to the 20 August close, and declined to assert a move. **This extract settles the 21 August 30-year at 5.2709% — a genuine rise of 2.33 bp.** Had the superseded \$9.25 been applied — 'a near-identical value in a live row is a market that has stopped moving' — the edition would have published an unchanged long end on a session in which it rose. The failure mode is **exact** equality, and it has now concealed a real move on three separate occasions.

Basis check (\$9.41): CLEARS on both contracts, and one is now resolved. The Brent CO2/COA basis runs **1.81, 1.72, 1.63, 1.31, 1.02** across 20–26 August — a smooth compression with no sign change and no step, so **there is no Brent roll in this window** and the day-on-day figures are comparable. The WTI CL2/CLA basis, which stepped from 0.00 to 1.90 on 21 August, now runs **1.90, 1.71, 1.48, 1.37**: the roll is behind us and the two series move together again. **WTI day-on-day is therefore comparable from 21 August forward, but NOT across the 20-to-21 August boundary.**

Restatement check: NO RESTATEMENT. All sixteen 20 August closes published in the 21 August edition — Brent, COA, WTI, Henry Hub, TTF, AsiaLNG, DXY, the full curve, 2s10s, BE10, 5y5y, MOVE and VIX — are unchanged to four decimal places in this extract. Absolute levels are therefore comparable with the 21 August edition, which is not always the case.

Skipped editions (\$9.20): there was no 24 and no 25 August edition. This edition covers a three-session window. The 21, 24 and 25 August closes are all published in full above rather than as day-on-day references. **w/w for the 25 August close runs against 18 August, five sheet-rows back.**

A1.2 · Reconciliation of the 21 August snapshot

THE SNAPSHOT MISSED IN BOTH DIRECTIONS AT ONCE, AND THE COMPOSITION IS THE READING (\$9.12, \$9.20). The 21 August edition published a Singapore-morning cut. Against the settled closes:

Field	Published 21 Aug snapshot	Settled 21 Aug close	Gap
Brent CO2	91.51	92.67	+\$1.16
Brent COA	93.32	94.39	+\$1.07
TTF	64.855	65.865	+€1.01
Henry Hub	2.760	2.773	+\$0.013
DXY	98.814	98.800	−0.014
2-year	4.1811	4.2359	+5.48 bp
5-year	4.3833	4.4242	+4.09 bp
10-year	4.7001	4.7339	+3.38 bp
2s10s	51.683	49.379	−2.30 bp
10y BE	2.3529	2.3328	−2.01 bp
5y5y fwd	2.3415	2.3168	−2.47 bp
30-year	EXCLUDED BY NAME	5.2709	Published UNRESOLVED; a reconciliation gap may NOT be computed against a carry (\$9.37)
WTI CL2	not reconciled	—	Roll boundary — a gap here would measure the roll, not the cut

Nominal yields were UNDERSTATED while inflation compensation was OVERSTATED. That means 21 August was a REAL-yield session — nominals up, breakevens down — and it is the opposite of the term-premium and inflation-compensation sessions that dominated the preceding fortnight. **Do not characterise it as 'the snapshot understated everything'; it did not, and the direction of the error differs by asset class.** \$9.37 is applied for the second time: the 30-year is excluded from the table by name rather than silently, because it was published UNRESOLVED and computing a gap against a carry measures staleness in the extract, not the timing of the Singapore cut.

NO NARRATIVE CONCLUSION FROM THE 21 AUGUST EDITION REQUIRES WITHDRAWAL THIS TIME (\$9.20, \$9.31). The three readings that edition offered — that the 20 August session was a data session rather than a supply session, that TTF had set a record close, and that Brent had closed to \$3.03 and \$1.22 of its upgrade — are all facts about the 20 August close, are unrestated, and survive. **What has changed is that the oil proximity has since reversed, which is a subsequent event and not an error in that edition.**

A1.3 · Energy — full commentary

Brent. Two consecutive down-closes: \$92.67 (21 Aug) to \$90.54 to **\$87.27**, with \$85.31 intraday on 26 August, the lowest print since the 13 August close of \$85.22. The two-close fall of \$5.40 is material but is **not** among the largest of the war — the worst three-session fall on record is \$16.60 into 28 July — and this document does not call it one. **Distances to the \$95 upgrade now read 9.78, 8.43, 5.55, 5.21, 3.03, 7.73: six readings, four narrowings, one widening.** On the active contract the sequence ends 1.22 then 6.42. **The July roll artifact remains an OPEN methodological item:** the scored CO2 continuation closed above \$95 on 23 and 24 July, days on which the active contract closed \$94.26 and \$91.68 and never cleared the trigger. Whether the channel should be scored on the continuation or the active is a real question that this edition does not settle under time pressure. **Never write that Brent has not closed above \$95 since the channel was cut to 2 on 3 July — it has, twice.**

The gas complex. TTF set a **new war-record close of €68.320 on 24 August**, its third record close in three sessions after €65.295 (20 Aug) and €65.865 (21 Aug), and the first above €68; it then fell to €66.588 and €63.690 intraday. Asia LNG set a **new war high of ¥3,793 on 25 August — the THIRD consecutive record close.** Be precise about the ordering: **¥3,628 on 21 August was the first print above the ¥3,601 of 23 July**, followed by ¥3,680 and ¥3,793. Against pre-war: TTF **+113.2%**, Asia LNG **+127.3%**, Henry Hub **–9.57%**. **A named, dated attribution for the 21–25 August European move could NOT be sourced to a named analyst at a named bank or consultancy;** the only dated attributions retrievable are commodity-desk notes (24 and 25 August) naming the Bessent sanctions package, delayed Qatari LNG deliveries and heat-driven cooling demand. **Report that as a desk note, not as an analyst call.** European storage stood at **62.99% on 24 August, 17.27 points below the five-year average and the lowest for the date since records began in 2011** — but this is a TASS calculation on GIE data and **gie.eu/agsi could not be read directly; treat the figure as Tier 2 pending verification.** No new Norwegian outage or extension is dated 22–26 August; Gassco's own feed was NOT OBTAINED. No QatarEnergy statement is dated in the window.

A1.4 · Rates and cross-asset — full commentary

The 25 August rally was broad and domestic. Every tenor fell 5.75 to 6.73 bp on soft US data. The 30-year closed **5.1651%, its lowest since the 5.0886% of 28 July.** The curve flattened to **45.257 bp on 2s10s, the flattest close since 7 August**, and to 44.585 intraday, the flattest since 6 August. **MOVE at 71.92 is the lowest close since the 71.26 of 19 August.** Bound the volatility superlative properly (\$9.32): six consecutive closes below 75 is **not** a war record — the war has seen runs of 21 sessions from 10 June, 17 from 9 April, 8 from 26 May and 7 from 6 May — **but it is the longest run since 10 June–10 July and double the best the regime that began on 29 July had produced (three closes, 12–14 August).** Equally, MOVE is **not** further from Threshold C than at any point in the war; the series low is 65.39 on 18 June.

Inflation compensation. 5y5y closed **2.2991%, below the 2.30% level whose sustained break fired this channel from 4 to 5 on 31 July.** That is the second such close in the current regime, after 2.2900% on 13 August; neither has been confirmed by a second close, and the 26 August intraday — which settles nothing — reads 2.3051%. The gap to the 2.142% downgrade anchor is **15.71 bp**, the narrowest since the 14.80 of 13 August. Ten-year breakeven compensation closed **2.3135%, 5.66 bp above its 2.2569% anchor**, from 9.56 bp on 20 August, when it was at its highest since 8 June. **The two series have retraced by DIFFERENT amounts — BE10 by more than a third of its distance from pre-war, 5y5y by about a fifth — in three sessions, in a week in which diesel set a war high — a market pricing the shock as a relative-price event rather than a price-level regime.**

A1.5 · Retail fuel — the direct reads, with denominators named

Series	Basis	Latest	Prior reference	Note
AUTMUSAG (Bloomberg)	AAA all-grades retail pump, daily, 1-day lag	\$4.82 (24 Aug)	\$4.82 (19, 20, 21 Aug)	THE SCORED SERIES. 22c above the \$4.60 downgrade condition, 7c above the \$4.75 trigger. 24 Aug UNRESOLVED (\$9.35)
AAA regular (website, read directly)	AAA regular grade national average	\$4.0969 (25 Aug)	\$4.0991 (24 Aug); \$4.1044 (20 Aug); \$4.1109 month ago	A DIFFERENT SERIES from AUTMUSAG. FELL over the window and sits below its month-ago level
AAA diesel (website, read directly)	AAA on-highway diesel national average	\$5.6199 (25 Aug)	\$5.6134 (24 Aug); \$5.4677 (18 Aug); \$5.2778 month ago	NEW WAR HIGH. 19.60c from the all-time record of \$5.8159 (19 Jun 2022). +15.22c in seven days, +34.21c in a month, +\$1.9384 y/y
USFRUSA (Bloomberg)	DOE/EIA regular-grade weekly survey	\$4.085 (24 Aug week)	\$4.049 (17 Aug); \$4.006 (10 Aug)	Corroboration only, never scored. +3.6c w/w
EIA on-highway diesel (website)	DOE/EIA weekly survey, released 25 Aug	\$5.652 (24 Aug week)	\$5.454 (17 Aug); \$5.257 (10 Aug)	+19.8c after +19.7c — two consecutive weeks of nearly twenty cents. California \$7.040 (+25.5c); Gulf Coast +24.4c

THE DECOUPLING IS THE FINDING. Diesel has risen close to 40 cents in a fortnight on both the daily and the weekly series while regular gasoline has fallen. **Distillate is where a routing and refining dislocation shows up first — it is the freight and industrial fuel, and US distillate stocks sit about 13% below their five-year average — whereas gasoline is the consumer-political series this monitor's political channel is scored on.** The channel is at its cap and the score is right, but the scored series is currently telling the reader less than the one beside it, and that should be said rather than smoothed over.

A1.6 · Strait operational — the full table, every provider, every denominator

Strand	Detail	Source and tier
UKMTO Update 089	ICOD 251500 UTC. Cumulative confirmed vessel incidents since 1 March: 96 , from 94 in Update 088 (ICOD 231500 UTC, which itself recorded NIL incidents since 087 and reported 94 unchanged). Strait of Hormuz SEVERE, unchanged ; the environment is still described as 'an established post-MoU status quo'. Gulf of Oman REDUCED from SUBSTANTIAL to MODERATE — the first threat-level reduction this monitor has recorded. (!) It is a RECLASSIFICATION, not a de-escalation: UKMTO's stated reasoning is that recent projectile strikes cluster near the Musandam Peninsula and are better classified as Strait of Hormuz events. Other levels: Arabian Gulf MODERATE, Arabian Sea MODERATE, Gulf of Aden SUBSTANTIAL, Bab el-Mandeb SUBSTANTIAL, Somali Basin MODERATE, N Red Sea/Suez MODERATE, E Med LOW. Mine danger areas remain ACTIVE in and adjacent to the TSS and clearance operations continue. AIS-on vessels can expect directed hails instructing diversion to the northern Iranian-controlled route	ukmto.org, Updates 088 and 089 read by DIRECT FILE URL (Tier 1). The product indexes render empty to a fetcher — direct file URL is the working method. Update 090 NOT FOUND

Strand	Detail	Source and tier
Numbered warnings	119-26 (24 Aug, 0705 UTC): tanker struck 63nm from Yanbu, northern Red Sea; small deck fire extinguished by crew; vessel proceeded under own power. Windward identifies her as AMZAN , IMO 9693745, a Saudi-flagged VLCC dark for 16.2 days before resurfacing; Bahri confirmed the incident with all crew safe; the Houthi military spokesman claimed it. NOT a Hormuz event. 120-26 (24 Aug, 2110 UTC): tanker struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room above the waterline; power lost, fire extinguished by the automatic system, vessel DISABLED and requiring tug assistance , all crew safe. (!) LOCATION DISCREPANCY, DO NOT RECONCILE: UKMTO's own text places it 3nm from the coast of Oman; media reporting places it 9nm northeast of Ash Shishah at 2057 UTC. Vessel unnamed by UKMTO and unnamed in all media; no claim of responsibility. Both post-date Update 088's ICOD, which is why the count moves to 96	UKMTO Warning 120-26 read directly (Tier 1); Windward 25 Aug; Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, UPI, Gulf News, Arab News 24–25 Aug
Transit counts — 24 August	FIVE counts for the same day, on five different vessel universes. They do not average and must never be spliced (\$9.24). UKMTO annex (S&P Global Maritime / SeaVision, NON-facilitated, >1,000 dwt): 1 cargo vessel and 0 tankers. Kpler via Reuters: 2 commodity vessels (one VLGC and one VLCC, both inbound), its lowest daily commodity tally since early May, against its own 10-day average of 14. Windward: 4 transits in the 24 hours to 24 Aug, ALL INBOUND — 3 Northern Corridor, 1 Southern; 3 AIS-visible, 1 dark. ZERO OUTBOUND , which Windward calls 'the clearest direct evidence yet of active enforcement against southbound traffic at the blockade line'; a 198m cargo vessel aborted an outbound run near the line and re-entered inbound. TankerMap (tankers only): 1. UKMTO US NCAGS-facilitated: 36 across the 23–24 Aug 48h — a FACILITATED SUBSET , an order of magnitude out from total traffic, and never comparable with the others. IMF PortWatch has published nothing after 23 Aug (3 crossings). Kpler 25 and 26 Aug: NOT FOUND. Lloyd's List: no Hormuz brief since 19 Aug — NOT OBTAINED, not unchanged. LSEG: NOT FOUND entirely	UKMTO 089 annex (Tier 1); Reuters citing Kpler 25 Aug (Tier 2, provider named); insights.windward.ai 25 Aug (Tier 1); tankermap.com (Tier 1); IMF PortWatch ArcGIS (Tier 1)
(!) Baseline register	NEVER quote a percentage of normal without naming the divisor (\$9.19), and one divisor has now changed under us. UKMTO/JMIC: ~138 vessels/day (2025 basis). Windward: ~140/day. Kpler: ~15 mb/d, a VOLUME basis, not vessels. TankerMap: ~21 tankers/day. IMF PortWatch: its JSON now returns a pre-crisis median of 85/day while its front page publishes 73/day — the SAME series with TWO published numbers. This document will not quote a PortWatch percentage without saying which divisor produced it. The ~130/day figure previously attributed to Al Jazeera could NOT be re-sourced in this window and is not used. Derived figures actually in circulation: ~90% below pre-conflict (UKMTO weekly AIS, week to 21 Aug, 192 vessels over seven days, denominator unstated in the quoted passage — and note it does NOT reconcile with UKMTO's own ~138/day, against which 192 over seven days is ~80% below. Quote the figure or the arithmetic, not both as if they agreed); ~40% of 2025 flows (Kpler, volume basis); 4% of pre-crisis (straits.live, dividing 3 by 85)	UKMTO 089 §4C; Windward; Kpler blog; straits.live /status JSON, 26 Aug
Blockade tally	71 commercial vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded as of 24 August , from 65/3/2 on 19 August — the intermediate prints are 68 (as of 21 Aug, recorded inside UKMTO Update 088) and 70 (23 Aug). CENTCOM publishes these through UKMTO and through its X account rather than through its own releases index. The PORT blockade has been enforced since 14 July (the tanker blockade was reinstated 13 July — two different measures, both dated here), and 40+ humanitarian vessels have been allowed through. No tally dated 25 or 26 August — NOT FOUND	UKMTO 088 and 089 (Tier 1); CENTCOM X via UPI 24 Aug and ANI 22 and 24 Aug (Tier 2)
CENTCOM and kinetic state	NO CENTCOM press release dated 22–26 August. This is a CONFIRMED NEGATIVE against the live PUBLIC-RELEASES index, not a retrieval failure — the index reads 15, 14, 13, 11, 5 Aug and then 29 July. The last combat release concerning operations inside Iran is 29 July: a 28-DAY GAP. (!) Silence is not inactivity , and the two must not be conflated: CENTCOM posts blockade tallies on X near-daily with named units. No US or Israeli strike inside Iran and no Iranian missile or drone launch anywhere in the window. The 18 August Iranian ballistic missiles against the UAE remain the only such event against a Gulf state since 4 May, remain denied by Tehran, and remain uncorroborated by any US or CENTCOM source into an eighth day — while being the stated basis for the UAE embargo. Carrier relief COMPLETE: the Lincoln left the theatre after a 274-day deployment and the George Washington CSG relieved her in the Arabian Sea. GW has NOT entered the Gulf of Oman or the Persian Gulf	centcom.mil index queried directly; USNI News 22 Aug and its own Fleet and Marine Tracker 24 Aug (Tier 1, two dated reports from ONE outlet)
Sanctions	'Operation Economic Outcast', Monday 24 August — the ONLY Iran action in the window; OFAC Recent Actions shows nothing on 22, 23, 25 or 26 August. Scale: 'nearly 60' per Treasury release sb0613 and 'over 60' per sb0614 (Bessent remarks), across UAE, Hong Kong, China, Singapore, Switzerland, Malaysia, UK and France. The structurally important element is FIVE NEW E.O. 13902 SECTOR DETERMINATIONS — aviation, digital assets, gold, shipping and technology — which broaden secondary-sanctions EXPOSURE rather than hitting a marquee target. General licences: F and G suspended (sports; academic exchange), AA and BB issued. Vessels designated with IMOs: SIFRA (9185346), G SILVER (9139696), QUANTUM HOPE (9233650), VOYAGE ELITE (9286138), TELA (9189110) — all flag-of-convenience registries. Chinese entities hit are procurement and shadow-banking fronts , not refiners. A Hormuz-specific instrument exists but is GUIDANCE: the updated OFAC alert 'Sanctions Risks of Iranian Demands for Strait of Hormuz Passage', the direct counterpart to Iran's transit-fee law. (!) NOT FOUND, and the omission is the analysis: no Chinese teapot refinery, no Chinese port, no Chinese bank, no new Iranian bank, no new executive order (Federal Register confirms), no ship-registry operator. Bessent, asked why: 'We are giving everyone the opportunity to remedy bad behaviour. Why would I want to blow up the global financial system?' He set a countdown and signalled a financial-institution designation 'before end of week'. EU, UK/OFSI, UN and Chinese counter-sanctions: all NOT FOUND	OFAC Recent Actions 20260824; Treasury sb0613 and sb0614; White House and State releases; Washington Post, NPR, CNBC, CNN, NBC, Al Jazeera all 24 Aug (Tier 1, multi-source)
Diplomacy — the Iran–Oman framework	Joint statement published on fm.gov.om (item 53722) on 25 August, following Busaidi's working visit to Tehran. Contents: a phased framework described as 'a practical and implementable basis for moving forward'; a temporary joint maritime corridor through the Strait; a joint mine-clearance project ; continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor and future arrangements for managing the Strait, with a mechanism for information exchange, traffic management and navigational and security services; and an affirmation of the importance of joint discussion with the Gulf littoral states. (!) THE NUANCE THAT MATTERS: this is a joint STATEMENT describing a PROPOSED framework. The Iran–Oman joint DECLARATION on which Qatar has gated all mediation is NOT issued. Busaidi on X: he hopes to 'soon announce' a temporary corridor, 'as per Article 5 of the Islamabad Memorandum' — the lapsed MoU is still being cited as the legal hook. Araghchi, 25 Aug: the agreement is 'very close', but full reopening depends on the US honouring the June MoU commitments it 'violated'; and separately that an Oman deal 'does not mean the strait is open'. No route coordinates published — NOT FOUND	fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Tier 1, primary); Al Jazeera (AFP+Reuters), Bloomberg, CNBC, Press TV all 25 Aug; Xinhua 26 Aug

Strand	Detail	Source and tier
Diplomacy — everything else	US–Iran talks NOT resumed and NONE scheduled — confirmed negative. Trump, 21 Aug: Iran 'would love to make a deal, but they're not ready to make the right deal'. Witkoff and Rubio: NOT FOUND anywhere in the window. THE PAKISTAN CHANNEL IS THE SUBSTANTIVE NEW MEDIATION EVENT: Field Marshal Asim Munir with Interior Minister Naqvi made a day-long Tehran visit on 24 August , meeting Pezeshkian, Ghalibaf, Araghchi and Rezaei; ISPR says talks covered 'measures to prevent further escalation, reopening of the Strait of Hormuz and expedited termination of the conflict'. A report that Trump telephoned Munir to relay a message to Tehran is single-source and treated as unconfirmed. QATAR, 25 Aug: Al Ansari says officials are on the phone 'on a daily basis' working to restart negotiations; sanctions 'do not directly affect' Qatar, which notes they are 'imposed by a specific party and are not UN sanctions'; and a categorical rejection of Iranian statements about targeting regional countries. SAUDI ARABIA, 24 Aug: MBS with Macron in Paris called for Hormuz navigation to return to its 'normal state' and opposed 'any direct or indirect tolls, or restrictions on passage'. UAE, 25 Aug: Gargash — 'the way out of this war does not lie in targeting the Gulf Arab states, but in working with them to create the conditions for de-escalation'. The UAE embargo of 19 Aug still has NO published implementing decree, cabinet resolution, carve-out, licence regime or CBUAE circular — one week on. NOT FOUND. No Iranian retaliation against the UAE and no other Gulf state has followed	Hegseth, Wisconsin remarks 24 Aug via ABC 25 Aug; ISPR via Al Jazeera 24–25 Aug and ABC 25 Aug; The Peninsula and Euronews 25 Aug; The National and A News 24–25 Aug (Tier 1/Tier 2 as marked)
Iranian measures and statements	23 Aug: Iran's National Security Commission approved Article 3 of the 'Strategic Action... Strait of Hormuz' law — TRANSIT SERVICE FEES payable in rials or a currency of Iran's choosing (spokesman Ebrahim Rezaei via IRIB, Tier 3, relayed by Al Jazeera). 23–24 Aug: the PGSA published a Non-Compliant Vessels list warning of fines, detention or confiscation, with contagion rules for STS partners. (!) TWO COUNTS FOR THE SAME LIST, REPORTED AND NOT RECONCILED: gCaptain says 46 ships, Reuters says 45 tankers. No listed vessel had been reported detained through 25 Aug. 22 Aug: Iran permitted some Iraqi oil tankers to transit. (!) SNSC Secretary Rezaei, 23 Aug, on state television: 'Why shouldn't we develop a nuclear weapon so that nobody can attack us?', adding that a nuclear weapon 'can be cheaper and more effective than having hundreds of F-35s'; he stopped short of saying Iran had decided to build one. Tier 2 reporting of Tier 3 source material, SINGLE-STREAM, no Tier 1 wire pickup located — flagged, and NOT used to move a probability. On 24 Aug he threatened that 'not a single drop of oil will be exported' and named Saudi and Emirati bypass pipeline routes; the same reporting stream records an internal Tehran debate over his authority to set such policy. Pezeshkian, 22 Aug, is notably dovish: 'we must get out of this situation of neither war nor peace', and 'with strength, but with logic'. Araghchi, late 21 Aug: 'Same bull. Different bullies.' Iran vows retaliation for the 24 Aug package	IRIB via Al Jazeera 23–24 Aug (Tier 3 relayed); gCaptain and Reuters 24–25 Aug; Iran International 22–25 Aug (Tier 2); Time, NBC and The Hill 25 Aug (Tier 1)
(!) The falsifiable claim of the week	Trump, 25 August: 'all mines have been removed and/or detonated from within the International Waters of the Strait of Hormuz', citing the Navy, with a 'Zero Tolerance policy' and a warning that any vessel laying new mines 'will be immediately and systematically destroyed'. Navy underwater drones are reported to have located more than 100 suspected mines over several months, with private contractors removing or detonating them. Axios reports two US officials with direct knowledge describing the Navy as having cleared the Traffic Separation Scheme — officials of the government making the claim, relayed by one outlet, which is corroborating detail and NOT independent confirmation. (!) THIS IS DIRECTLY CONTRADICTED BY UKMTO UPDATE 089, PUBLISHED THE SAME DAY, WHICH STATES THAT MINE DANGER AREAS REMAIN ACTIVE IN AND ADJACENT TO THE TSS AND THAT CLEARANCE OPERATIONS CONTINUE. This document reports both and reconciles neither. Update 090 and VRA Overview No. 4 settle it. Note also that a tanker was DISABLED by a projectile in Omani waters roughly twenty-four hours before the declaration	Axios, Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, Al-Monitor, UPI, Korea JoongAng Daily all 25 Aug (Tier 1, multi-source); UKMTO Update 089 read directly (Tier 1)
Physical Iranian crude	Windward, 24–25 Aug: the Kharg Island dark-tanker waiting area holds 20 dark tankers carrying an assessed 21–23 mn bbl combined. A Nicaragua-flagged tanker broadcasting the name SYRON is assessed loading at Kharg's eastern terminal; its IMO matches SARAK, an OFAC-sanctioned Iranian tanker dark since 20 July. Kpler via Reuters, 21 Aug: Iranian crude stored aboard tankers OUTSIDE the US blockade zone is ~80 mn bbl, from ~105 mn before the blockade was reinstated on 13 July. (!) DEFINITIONAL TRAP: this is a DIFFERENT series from the 110 mn bbl of 18 August, which was crude on water INSIDE the Mideast Gulf and Gulf of Oman. Do NOT print 110 → 80 as a decline. China's Iranian crude imports 534 kb/d month-to-date August, against ~823 kb/d in July and a 1.4 mb/d 2025 average. An updated Iranian loading rate in kb/d for 18–26 August: NOT OBTAINED — the 156 kb/d through 17 August has no successor, and Kpler's weekly MoU series concluded on 19 August. AMARA (IMO 9333280), Liberia-flagged, has been held stationary near Qeshm Island since 20 August, consistent with an ongoing seizure. No party has confirmed it; if it is one, it is the first Iranian seizure since 22 June	insights.windward.ai 24–25 Aug (Tier 1); Reuters citing Kpler 21 Aug (Tier 2, provider named)
Freight and war-risk insurance	(!) METHODOLOGY BREAK: the week-33 aggregate TCE figures this monitor has been carrying (VLCC \$234,821/day, Suezmax \$269,824, Aframax \$77,182) come from an AGGREGATE SUMMARY series that the week-34 Baltic report does not contain. A like-for-like week-34 aggregate is NOT OBTAINED. Route-level figures are not a continuation of that series and are labelled as such. Baltic week 34, dated 21 Aug, route level: VLCC TD3C MEG–China WS570, +88 points, round-trip TCE ~\$585,000/day; TD34 Gulf of Oman–China ~\$197,800/day; Suezmax TD20 >\$165,000/day; Aframax TD7 ~\$93,200/day. Week 35 NOT PUBLISHED — due 28 Aug. Lloyd's List assessed TD3C above \$520,000/day on 19 August; that is a DIFFERENT assessment on a DIFFERENT basis from Baltic's and the two are not a time series. WAR RISK — EXPLICIT NEGATIVE: no named broker or underwriter has published a percentage-of-hull figure dated 22–26 August. Marsh at 7.5–10% of hull, dated 22 July, remains the newest sourced point estimate. Marsh's Marcus Baker (27 Jul) described corridor war-risk demand as having 'all but disappeared' and gave a ~0.25% to 10% range ACROSS the year, which is not a fresh point estimate. A '5 to 10 percent' figure circulating on 24 August has NO named broker and is not used; straits.live's multiples are its own editorial estimate, not a market quote. Joint War Committee: no update; latest is JWLA-034, 29 July	Baltic Exchange tanker report week 34 read directly (Tier 1); Lloyd's List 19 Aug (Tier 2); Insurance Business citing Marsh and WTW (Tier 2)

A2.3 · CROSS-ASSET AND MACRO RECORD — FULL

Released and obtained, 22–26 August. Conference Board consumer confidence (25 Aug): headline 89.4 against 90.2 consensus and 90.2 prior — **the weakest since January**. Present Situation 121.2, +6.8, its first rise in four months; **Expectations 68.2, –5.8, below the 80 recession threshold**. Survey period 3–16 August. **The write-in commentary is directly on this monitor's subject: references to prices in general 'and oil and gas specifically—remain elevated', and comments about war and conflict ROSE in August.** The Board publishes no numeric inflation expectation, only that directional phrase — **do not invent a number for it**. **New home sales, July (25 Aug): 607,000 SAAR, –10.5% m/m, –6.3% y/y**; inventory 488,000, 9.6 months' supply; median price \$393,800, the lowest in over a year. **S&P Cotality Case-Shiller, June (25 Aug): 20-city +2.1% y/y from +1.6%, national +1.5%, 10-city +2.9%**; Chicago +6.9% and New York +4.8% lead, Seattle –2.0% lags; **a thirteenth consecutive month in which home values fell in REAL terms** against the 3.5% inflation the index benchmarks to. **Chicago Fed National Activity Index, July (24 Aug): –0.08 from +0.06, three-month average –0.04, the swing driven by personal consumption and housing at –0.09 from +0.04. Jobless claims: the 206,000 print (week to 15 Aug, –6,000) was released 20 August, TWO days BEFORE this window opens — do not date it into it.** Continuing claims 1,799,000. The next release is 27 August. **The following releases fall inside the window but land AFTER the Singapore cut, and are therefore NOT OBTAINED.** All three of **durable goods (July), the Q2 GDP second estimate and July PCE** were released at 08:30 ET on 26 August and are absent from this edition. For reference, the Q2 advance print was **+1.5% SAAR with a gross domestic purchases price index of +5.7%** against +3.6% in Q1 — that price measure is the energy shock's signature in the national accounts. June PCE ran –0.1% m/m headline and +0.1% core, +3.7% and +3.3% y/y. **Atlanta Fed GDPNow still reads 4.0%, dated 18 August; the 26 August revision had not posted. (!) Flag the gap rather than smoothing it: a 4.0% Q3 nowcast against a 1.5% Q2 advance print is very wide and is model-driven, not consensus.** **The 26 August EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report, due 10:30 ET, is also NOT OBTAINED — so crude stocks, the crude imports line, refinery runs, product stocks and, critically, WHETHER THE SPR DREW AGAIN are all unknown.** Standing figures from the week to 14 August: commercial crude 428.8 mn bbl (+4.4 mn); **SPR 293.4 mn bbl, DOWN 5.3 mn on the week from 298.7 mn, against 403.4 mn a year ago and ~415 mn pre-war — the lowest since 1982/83**; crude imports 6.6 mb/d, –746 kb/d, four-week average **6.5 mb/d (this supersedes the ~6.3 mb/d four-week average carried in prior editions)**; refinery utilisation 97.2%; distillate stocks 105.6 mn, **~13% below the five-year average. (!) The ir.eia.gov/wpsr/wpsrsummary.pdf endpoint served a December 2025 document to a fetcher — do not trust it.** No EIA STEO, IEA OMR or OPEC MOMR falls in this window; all are mid-month publications. **Rates, the Fed and the auction calendar. (!) CORRECT A STANDING FRAMING: the Fed is priced for a September HIKE, not a cut.** The 28–29 July FOMC held at 3.50–3.75% on a 9–3 vote with all three dissents **FOR A HIKE** (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan). **A direct CME FedWatch print could NOT be obtained — the tool is a JavaScript embed and returns nothing to a fetcher — and the aggregator figures in circulation (roughly 40–42% hike, 0% cut, dated 25 Aug) are Tier 3 and are not relied on.** The better-sourced alternative is J.P. Morgan Wealth Management's 5 August move to a 25 bp September hike base case, whose chief investment strategist named 'a slower-than-expected normalization of supply chains around the Strait of Hormuz' as a reason. **No Federal Reserve Board speech falls between 5 and 26 August — a VERIFIED silence rather than a search failure. No causal gloss is offered for it; the FOMC blackout runs to a meeting, not to a symposium, and does not by itself explain a three-week gap.** Jackson Hole runs 27–29 August; the theme is 'Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy'; Warsh's first keynote as Chair is 10:00 ET on Friday 28 August. The full programme is NOT RETRIEVABLE. **Because the 2026 theme is payments rather than supply shocks, any signal on the energy shock will come outside the formal programme.** On buybacks: the 19 August announcement raising long-end operations from \$2bn to at least \$4bn each, 9 September to 4 November, is confirmed against Treasury release sb0607; **no updated schedule has been published — NOT OBTAINED.** A 24 August report that Bessent could tap the Treasury General Account to fund buybacks is **anonymously sourced and attributed to the outlet, not to Treasury.**

A2.3.1 · Auction internals, 22–26 August, with the 27 August 7-year listed for completeness

Security	Date	Size	High yield / rate	B/C	Primary dealer / direct / indirect
2-year note (91282CRH6)	25 Aug	\$69bn	4.2040% , coupon 4.125%, 85.68% allotted at the high	2.60	On competitive-accepted (\$68.107bn): 10.90% / 23.09% / 66.01%. On total-award-ex-SOMA (\$69.000bn): 10.76% / 22.79% / 65.16%
13-week bill	24 Aug	\$92bn	3.715% (3.803% inv.)	3.08	32.87% / 7.95% / 59.17% (competitive-accepted)
26-week bill	24 Aug	\$79bn	3.790% (3.918% inv.)	3.05	28.63% / 11.20% / 60.16% (competitive-accepted)
6-week bill	25 Aug	\$95bn	3.650% (3.717% inv.)	2.71	33.07% / 1.73% / 65.20% (competitive-accepted)
5-year note (91282CRK9)	26 Aug	\$70bn	NOT OBTAINED — auctioned after the Singapore cut	—	—
2-year FRN reopening (91282CRD5)	26 Aug	\$28bn	NOT OBTAINED	—	—
7-year note (91282CRJ2)	27 Aug	\$44bn	Outside the window	—	—

\$9.40 applies and the denominator is named both ways. Treasury computes bid-to-cover ex-SOMA; computing it on raw totals gives 2.42 rather than 2.60 and is a common error. **The composition is where the signal is (\$9.29), and it is now a RUN rather than an observation: three consecutive coupon auctions have cleared with a primary-dealer backstop in single or low double digits — 12.34% on the 20-year (19 Aug), 2.09% on the \$8bn 30-year TIPS (20 Aug), and 10.90% here.** Paper is clearing, and it is clearing away from dealers. **A tail is NOT computed and NOT asserted for any of these: Treasury publishes no when-issued level, so a tail is structurally unobtainable from primary data (\$9.39).** One loose end: the 2-year carries a special announcement, SPL_20260820_1.pdf, which returned empty to a fetcher and is **NOT OBTAINED**.

A7 · SOURCE LOG

Tier	Sources used in this edition
Tier 1 — market data	Tecity Bloomberg extract, <i>US Iran BBG Data.xlsx</i>, refreshed 26 August 2026. Tickers CO2, COA, CL2, CLA, NGA, TZTA, JGLA, USGG2YR/5YR/10YR/20YR/30YR, USYC2Y10, USGGBE10, USGG5Y5Y, SOFRRATE, MOVE, VIX, AUTMUSAG, USRFRUSA, DXY. Header row scanned dynamically; column indices are never hardcoded. ALL prices, yields, spreads and both gasoline series in this document come only from this extract and never from the web.
Tier 1 — primary documents read directly	UKMTO Update 088 (ICOD 231500Z) and Update 089 (ICOD 251500Z) , plus Warning 120-26 and VRA Overview No. 3 (21 Aug), all by DIRECT FILE URL on ukmt0.org · api.fiscaldata.treasury.gov auctions_query · OFAC Recent Actions 20260824 and Treasury releases sb0607, sb0613, sb0614 · Federal Register · centcom.mil PUBLIC-RELEASES index · fm.gov.om item 53722 · gasprices.aaa.com · eia.gov Gasoline & Diesel Fuel Update and Weekly Petroleum Status Report · Conference Board and S&P Cotality release texts · DOL claims release · Kansas City Fed symposium page · IMF PortWatch ArcGIS · insights.windward.ai · tankernmap.com · Baltic Exchange tanker report week 34
Tier 1 — news	Reuters 21, 24 and 25 Aug — where Reuters relays Kpler it is treated as Tier 2 with the provider named, per A1.6 · Al Jazeera 23, 24 and 25 Aug · Bloomberg 24 and 25 Aug · CNBC 24 and 25 Aug · Axios 25 Aug · Washington Post, NPR, NBC, CNN, CBS, PBS 24–25 Aug · USNI News 22 and 24 Aug · UPI 24 Aug · Al Arabiya and Jerusalem Post 25 Aug · The National and A News 24–25 Aug · The Peninsula and Euronews 25 Aug · gCaptain 24 Aug · Time and The Hill 25 Aug
Tier 2 — single-source, trade press, or a named provider relayed	Lloyd's List 19 Aug (TD3C) · Insurance Business citing Marsh and WTW · Trading Economics commodity desk 24 and 25 Aug (the ONLY dated attribution obtainable for the European gas move) · TASS calculation on GIE data for European storage · MNI on the Warsh keynote time · Iran International 22–25 Aug · ANI 22 and 24 Aug · ISPR via wire · RTTNews and investingLive on the 2-year auction · J.P. Morgan Wealth Management, 5 Aug
Tier 3 — state media, labelled and not used for anything market-moving	IRIB and IRNA on the transit-fee law and on Rezaei's remarks · Mehr News 25 Aug (a single-commodity-vessel claim for 24 Aug with no named provider, against Kpler's two) · Press TV 25 Aug · WAM on the UAE embargo · Xinhua 26 Aug
(!) REJECTED or NOT USED	A claim that IAEA Director-General Grossi travelled to Tehran on 24 August could not be substantiated on re-query and is NOT PUBLISHED. · A '5 to 10 percent of hull' war-risk figure dated 24 Aug has no named broker and is not used. · straits.live's insurance multiples are its own editorial estimates. · GlobalSecurity.org's 25 Aug daily summary contains two verifiable errors — it misses both 24 August shipping attacks — and is not treated as authoritative on maritime incidents. · A commentary dating Warsh's keynote to Sunday 23 August is false against the Kansas City Fed's own page. · A Bloomberg item on Iranian barrels dated 24 Aug could not be opened and is not relied on. · (!) A DATE TRAP: queries in this area surface the 28 August 2025 E3 snapback activation. That is 2025.
NOT OBTAINED register	UKMTO Update 090 and VRA Overview No. 4 · UKMTO Warning 121-26 or later · CENTCOM blockade tally for 25 or 26 Aug · Kpler counts for 25 or 26 Aug · Lloyd's List transit count for 17–23 Aug (no brief since 19 Aug) · LSEG entirely · Windward per-day counts for 20–23 Aug · Iranian crude loadings in kb/d for 18–26 Aug · Kharg terminal throughput · the name of the tanker disabled on 24 Aug · UAE implementing decree, carve-out or licence regime · EU, UK/OFSI and UN action · Chinese counter-sanctions · the 26 Aug EIA weekly INCLUDING THE SPR LEVEL · 26 Aug durable goods, GDP second estimate and PCE · the 26 Aug GDPNow revision · a direct CME FedWatch print · 5-year and 7-year auction results · the updated Treasury buyback schedule · SPL_20260820_1.pdf · Baltic week 34 aggregate TCEs and week 35 · a named-broker war-risk figure newer than 22 July · gie.eu/agsi and Gassco UMM direct reads · the Jackson Hole programme · Richmond Fed August (publication could not be confirmed; no Richmond number is printed)

A8 · ON-DEMAND UPDATE PROTOCOL

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh and verify the extract	Never build an edition off a stale extract (\$9.22). Check the file mtime AND parse the sheet — a stale mtime and a stale row are different failures. If the latest row is not newer than the last edition, stop and say so.
2	Parse with a dynamic header scan	Column indices move between uploads. Auto-detect the Brent and WTI front month and take whatever label the header scan returns for DXY. Re-verify the 27 February anchor field by field.
3	Run all THREE integrity checks	Row-level (\$9.8), field-level identical-to-4dp (\$9.35), and the continuation-versus-active BASIS check (\$9.41). All three ran on this edition; the field-level check fired twice and the basis check cleared.
4	Compute deltas and test every trigger	d/d, w/w five rows back, and versus pre-war; explicit trigger tests for the four market channels plus Stage-4 A, B and C. Run min, max and last-prior-occurrence on the full column before writing ANY superlative (\$9.32).
5	Verify the news, and re-verify what was inherited	Every claim needs a named source and an exact date, and negative claims decay fastest of all (\$9.23). State the exact query behind every negative. Say NOT OBTAINED rather than estimating.
6	Build, then QA in three passes	A numeric harness against the dataframe; an adversarial PROSE pass by a reviewer with no access to the source data, run TWICE because fixing introduces defects (\$9.42); and a VISUAL render. Re-run the numeric harness AFTER the prose fixes.
7	Deliver both documents	The edition and the annex go into the project root together. A file that is not committed never reaches the reader. The annex does not go into the dashboard PDF folder.

A9 · METHODOLOGY

Six channels, each scored 0–5, summed to 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch; 8–14 stress; 15–21 systemic-risk watch; 22–30 crisis. Maritime denial and escalation risk are event channels; oil, US inflation impulse, Treasury stress and political stress are market channels scored on confirmed closes.

(a) Confirmed closes only for market channels. No market channel moves on an intraday print. The 26 August snapshot in this document moves nothing. **(b) Hysteresis.** Upgrades fire on a sustained break; downgrades require a sustained reversal past a **wider** threshold. This is why the Treasury channel holds at 5 with its volatility leg satisfied for a sixth session, and why the US-inflation channel holds at 5 with its own firing trigger broken. **(c) The scale saturates in BOTH directions (\$9.7, \$9.27).** FIVE of six channels are at the cap, so deterioration cannot raise this score through any of them — the sole remaining route up is the oil channel at 2 — and no amount of financial improvement short of a documented downgrade can lower it. **A flat 27 does not mean a stable situation and this document says so every time it prints one.** **Rules exercised this edition, named so the reader can audit them. \$9.11** — an announcement is not an event; the escalation channel holds despite an issued framework. **\$9.15 and \$9.18** — both are amended in the open: the Treasury legs converged on 25 August, which

§9.15 said they did not do, and §9.18's 'one close is a session, not a regime' stops applying at six consecutive closes. **§9.19 and §9.40** — every denominator named, on transit counts and on auction allotments alike. **§9.20** — an edition was skipped, so the missed closes are published in full. **§9.24** — four providers gave five transit counts on five vessel universes for 24 August, and all five are published. **§9.26** — the trigger that fired the US-inflation upgrade broke again and the rule was NOT moved to match it. **§9.32** — every superlative bounded to a named window and checked against the full column; the MOVE run and the Threshold C distance were both trimmed in draft as a result. **§9.35** — two identical-to-4dp fields reported UNRESOLVED, and the rule vindicated for a third time on the 21 August 30-year. **§9.36 and §9.41** — both oil bases quoted, basis check run and cleared. **§9.37** — the 30-year excluded from the reconciliation by name because a gap may not be computed against a carry. **§9.39** — Threshold A reported as untestable as written rather than as declining to arm.

Restatements and comparability. Vendor restatements are normal and make absolute levels non-comparable across editions, though directional analysis is continuous. **No restatement occurred this edition.** A contract roll does the same thing to a continuation series silently, which is why the basis check is now a standing check. **The dual gasoline series is never re-based: AUTMUSAG is the scored reference and preserves the \$3.52 anchor and the \$4.75 trigger; USRFRUSA is corroboration only.** The pre-war anchor is the 27 February 2026 close and is re-verified field by field every edition; it is unchanged to date.

A10 · ANCHOR AND TRIGGER LEVELS

A10.1 · Pre-war anchor — 27 February 2026 close, re-verified this edition, unchanged

Brent	WTI	2Y	5Y	10Y	30Y	2s10s	5y5y	10y BE	MOVE	VIX	DXY	Gasoline AAA	Henry Hub	TTF	Asia LNG
\$72.48	\$67.02	3.3749 %	3.502 %	3.9375 %	4.6106 %	+55.64	2.142%	2.257%	73.38	19.86	97.608	\$3.52	\$3.063	€31.23	¥1,669

A10.2 · Live trigger state on the 25 August close

Channel	Score	Upgrade	Downgrade	Distance
Maritime denial	5	At max	Verified reopening AND traffic above 25% of normal for 10 sessions	Neither leg close; the traffic leg moved AWAY this week
Oil price shock	2	Brent above \$95 sustained → 3	Mediated pause AND a close at or below \$72.48 → 1	Upgrade \$7.73 on CO2, \$6.42 on the active — WIDENED from \$3.03 / \$1.22. Downgrade price leg \$14.79
US inflation impulse	5	At max	5y5y sustained at or below the 2.142% anchor → 4	15.71 bp, narrowed from 20.12. NOTE: the 2.30% level that FIRED the upgrade was breached on the close
Treasury stress	5	At max	30-year close below 5.00% WITH MOVE below 75, sustained → 4	Yield leg fails by 16.51 bp, narrowest since 28 Jul; volatility leg satisfied for a SIXTH consecutive close. BOTH LEGS CONVERGED
Political stress	5	At max	Three consecutive AUTMUSAG closes at or below \$4.60 with no intervening print above \$4.70 → 4	22 cents, unchanged. Latest print \$4.82 (24 Aug), UNRESOLVED under \$9.35
Escalation risk	5	At max	Mediated stand-down AND talks resume → 4–3	Stand-down leg is the closest of the war; the talks leg is unmoved — none convened, none scheduled
Stage-4 A	—	Failed-auction test: an auction clearing with a tail above its when-issued level	—	NOT ARMED — UNTESTABLE AS WRITTEN (§9.39). Treasury publishes no when-issued level, so no primary source can ever confirm a tail
Stage-4 B	—	30-year above 5.20% AND 10-year above 4.65%	—	LAPSED on the 25 Aug close, on BOTH legs — short by 3.49 and 2.12 bp. Sixth lapse, eleventh state, tenth change since 29 July
Stage-4 C	—	MOVE above 130	—	71.92 — 58.08 points below. NOT the furthest of the war; the series low is 65.39 on 18 June